



Adaptive Soundtrack Guide

Big Bad Wolf Saloon — Wild-West Video Slot



Document	Adaptive Soundtrack Guide
Project	Big Bad Wolf Saloon
Type	Music cue sheet & review
Date	2026-06-03

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The Idea

The score is **adaptive** — a small "Conductor" stays aware of what's happening and shapes the music to match, the same way the wolf's voice reacts to the game. Instead of one song looping (or starting and stopping), a continuous bed plays underneath while extra layers **fade in and out** and the tempo gently leans forward as the player heats up. The only hard cuts are deliberate crossfades at big moments (day→night, base→bonus).

Everything is in one musical family — base cues in **A minor around 92 BPM**, bonus cues in **A minor around 120 BPM** — so any two cues blend cleanly. Generated with ElevenLabs Music.

The Track Library

Six cues: two swappable base beds, a base energy layer, a two-track bonus playlist, and a bonus energy layer.

TRACK	ROLE	LOOP	KEY · BPM	CHARACTER	FILE
Day Bed	Base · bed	40s	A min · ~92	Warm, sunlit, hopeful frontier morning — fingerpicked guitar, soft banjo, harmonica, light strings. Low-to-mid energy.	bgm_base_day.mp3
Night Bed	Base · bed	40s	A min · ~92	Sparse, moonlit and lonesome — slide guitar, low strings, distant harmonica and a faint wolf howl. A touch of menace.	bgm_base_night.mp3
Base Energy	Base · layer	32s	A min · 92	Additive percussion layer — galloping banjo, stomps & claps, toms, brass stabs. Fades IN on top of the bed as heat rises.	bgm_base_energy.mp3
Bonus Theme A	Bonus · bed	48s	A min · 120	Epic, triumphant Western adventure — heroic brass, galloping fiddle & banjo, big drums. Track 1 of the bonus playlist.	bgm_bonus_a.mp3
Bonus Theme B	Bonus · bed	48s	A min · 120	A bolder hoedown-meets-orchestra variation that crossfades with A so the bonus reads as a playlist, not one loop.	bgm_bonus_b.mp3

TRACK	ROLE	LOOP	KEY · BPM	CHARACTER	FILE
Bonus Energy	Bonus · layer	32s	A min · 120	Peak-excitement overlay — war-drum toms, galloping snare, stabbing brass. Sits on the bonus bed; always has a floor.	bgm_bonus_energy.mp3

What Triggers What — the "Heat" System

A single hidden **heat** value (0→1) rises with action and decays when the player idles. The Conductor pushes it to the music several times a second, so the energy layer and tempo follow the moment smoothly rather than in jumps.

WHEN THIS HAPPENS...	...THE MUSIC DOES THIS
Fast / repeated spinning	Heat ↑ → the energy layer swells in and (desktop) the tempo leans forward up to +8%.
A win lands	Heat ↑, scaled by size: a small win nudges it, a big win spikes it.
Win streak (3+ in a row)	A rising stinger ladder — each consecutive win plays a pip a step higher in pitch.
A really big win (25×+)	The wolf-howl motif punctuates the moment over the music.
Near-miss / bonus anticipation	A tension riser swells under the reels as they slow.
Bonus enter / exit	Crossfade to the bonus playlist (and back). The bonus keeps an energetic floor so it always feels big.
Time-of-day slider	The base bed crossfades Day ↔ Night as it crosses dusk/dawn.
Player adds credit	A short celebratory deposit flourish + a touch of heat.
Player idles	Heat decays steadily — the energy layer melts away and the score relaxes back to the bed.

Musical Stingers

Short one-shots the Conductor fires *over* the bed on specific events (these don't loop).

STINGER	FIRES WHEN	FILE
Streak step	Each win from the 3rd in a row; pitch climbs with the streak length.	streak_step.mp3
Big-win howl	A 25×+ win — the wolf howls.	wolf_howl.mp3

STINGER	FIRES WHEN	FILE
Deposit flourish	Player adds credit.	deposit_flourish.mp3
Tension riser	Reel anticipation / near-miss.	music_riser.mp3

How the Blend Works

- **Beds are continuous** — the base bed (or bonus bed) never stops; we add and remove layers on top of it.
- **Energy layers are additive** — percussion-forward, mixed gently, swelling in with heat and melting out when it cools.
- **Crossfades only at context changes** — day↔night and base↔bonus dissolve smoothly; nothing else hard-cuts.
- **Subtle dynamic tempo** — the score speeds up to about +8% at peak heat, pitch-preserved so it never sounds sped-up.
- **The bonus is a mini-playlist** — Theme A and Theme B trade off so a long bonus never feels like one loop.

Desktop vs. mobile. Phones run a deliberately lighter mix — beds, the energy layer and all crossfades still play, but dynamic tempo is off (iOS time-stretch is poor) and the bonus A/B swap is skipped, to keep playback smooth.

Tuning. Reactivity is a single knob. In a dev build, `window.__score.gain(0.6)` calms it and `gain(1.4)` makes it punchier; `window.__score.heat()` shows the live value. Heat decay, the energy ceiling and the tempo range are all single constants in `src/audio`.